

PatentPincer

Describe an invention. Get a cited patentability verdict in a minute.

doom2quake · DevNetwork [API + Cloud + AI] 2026 · SerpApi

The problem

A prior-art search is the **first** thing a founder needs and the **last** thing they can afford.

An attorney charges four figures and takes a week to say whether your idea is already patented.

Most founders skip it and find out the expensive way, **after** they have built.

The idea

Describe the invention in one sentence:

```
patentpincer assess "a wearable that estimates  
hydration from sweat conductivity"
```

Get back a decision: **file it, narrow it, or walk away**, with the closest reference and why.

How it works

Four steps, the way an attorney actually works:

1. **Search prior art.** SerpApi Google Patents (widened recall) + Scholar for non-patent literature.
2. **Fetch the claims.** SerpApi Patents **Details** returns the numbered claims.
A snippet is not a claim.
3. **Compare element by element.** Every cell names the reference, the claim number, the matched terms and the excerpt.
4. **Render a verdict.** One line the router can act on.

SerpApi is the evidence. The agent is the analyst.

The demo

1. Filing text in → SerpApi surfaces prior art with **overlap bars**.
2. The analyst compares your claim against numbered claims, element by element.
3. A verdict stamp lands:
 - CLEAR** .
 - NEEDS_REVIEW** .
 - HIGH_OVERLAP** .
 - SEARCH_UNAVAILABLE** → routed (loud alert on a likely collision **or** on a failed search).

It refuses rather than guesses

What happened	What you get
No search succeeded	<code>SEARCH_UNAVAILABLE</code> + alert
Zero references returned	<code>NEEDS_REVIEW</code>
No claim text retrieved	<code>SEARCH_UNAVAILABLE</code>
Offline corpus, not live SerpApi	a computed <code>CLEAR</code> is downgraded

A search that did not happen is never a clearance.

Proven

38 tests (`pytest`), no network, no API key:

- Offline records are labelled `fixture`, never `ok`; unknown queries are refused.
- Dry-run, timeout, error body, zero results and missing claims **fail closed**.
- A `CLEAR` brief containing "high overlap" still routes as a clearance.
- Concurrent runs keep separate ledgers and **spend budgets**.
- The MCP server boots for real and serves the three SerpApi tools.
- The shipped UI replays runs that reproduce exactly.

No funded key on this build: recorded runs are FIXTURE and the demo says so. The live path is covered with faked SerpApi responses.

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github.com/doom2quake/patentpincer